

Chapter 106_2 - Return

Ning Fuyi's nose tip slid past the soft flower petals, deeply memorizing their fragrance. Then she closed her eyes and cast her spell, light points whiter than snow breaking through the snow.

The moment they touched the air, the light points exploded silently, so bright that people couldn't open their eyes, so bright that even the heavenly light lost its color.

At the same time, the glass lamp that had held the gardenia flower for thirty years cracked with a snap. The gardenia flower expanded a hundredfold and floated into mid-air, its petals fading to phantoms that touched the sky above and pressed the earth below, with all the light points falling into the flower's heart.

Ancient ballads descended from the sky, like the low hymns of the gods.

Ning Fuyi's skull immediately transmitted sharp pain. She silently knelt in the snow, covering her head and gritting her teeth, enduring the blazing light to look up at mid-air, watching the flower transform back to ordinary and fly toward the horizon.

The ballad became clearer, as if sending off the flower. Ning Fuyi could no longer hold on and collapsed before the tombstone, her consciousness blurred.

Someone in the distance was calling her name. Ning Fuyi, with blood in her mouth, curled up her body and laughed silently.

Chu Qingqiu had returned. She had finally returned.

On this day, the celestial phenomena were greatly abnormal. Snow fell across the four seas and eight wilderness¹, and even the great desert that had been dry for many years was covered with ice and snow. All the immortal sects urgently gathered to discuss, only to discover that Purple Cloud Peak, which had been silent for many years, now blazed with violet light, like lighting a celestial lantern for the six realms.

Overnight, a hundred flowers bloomed together, blossoming amid the heavy snow in a scene both eerie and lasting for many days without fading.

Thus all the immortal sects sent people to Purple Cloud Peak to investigate. Cloud Ascension Mountain Gate had the advantage of proximity, and on the very day of the phenomenon, they led numerous disciples to ascend the peak.

At that time, the celestial lantern had just extinguished, and the rich floral fragrance lingered for a long time. A group of elders landed before the stone gate, only to see it suddenly open wide, with frost flowers blooming from the ice and snow that filled the hall, spreading from inside to outside the gate.

A cold woman walked out in confusion, extending her jade-white hand to catch the coldness from above.

Remaining tears slid down her cheeks, melting in the wind.

She seemed to have had an extremely long dream, in which she died, and before dying, she watched the heaviest snow of her life.

"Divine Venerable, it's truly the Divine Venerable!"

"The Divine Venerable has undergone nirvana² and been reborn, truly heaven blesses our Cloud Ascension Mountain Gate, heaven blesses our six realms!" Countless disciples cried out in shock, and the elders were also overjoyed, quickly scolding the disciples to kneel and pay their respects.

Soon, deafening voices echoed throughout the mountains.

"Disciples pay respects to the Divine Venerable!"

"We welcome the sect master's return!"

The woman lowered her eyes to look at the densely packed crowd kneeling on the ground, their shouts seeming to awaken her.

The sorrow and fragility in her eyes disappeared, the softness belonging to Su Mo faded away, returning to a gaze full of frost.

Then she raised her hand: "Rise."

¹ Four seas and eight wilderness (四海八荒) - A Chinese expression meaning "everywhere in the world" or "the entire world"

² Nirvana (涅槃) - A Buddhist concept referring to the liberation from suffering and the cycle of rebirth; in cultivation novels, it often refers to a process of death and rebirth that leads to greater power